

▼ WINGED SPEARHEAD

Date 700–800CE

Origin Northern Europe

Length 47cm (18½in)

This lugged or “winged” iron spearhead has a leaf-shaped blade and a tapered iron socket. The wings could prevent the spear blade from getting stuck in an opponent’s body or hook a shield out of the way.



Decoration
also helps
provide grip

▼ LATE VIKING SWORD

Date 900–1000CE

Origin Northern Europe

Weight 1.5kg (3¼lb)

Length 80–100cm (32–39in)

As with most swords found on archaeological sites, this later Viking sword blade is badly corroded, making the interpretation of runic inscriptions on the blade very difficult. Its wooden scabbard and hilt have also rotted away.



Blade tapers more
towards the point

▲ VIKING SWORD HILT

Date 950–1050CE

Origin Northern Europe

Length 25cm (10in)

Crafted from copper and inlaid with geometric designs in silver, this ornate hilt was too fine to be used in battle, and probably belonged to a chieftain.



Two-edged
pattern-welded blade

▼ TAPERED SWORD

Date 900–1100CE

Origin Scandinavia

Weight 1.5kg (3¼lb)

Length 90cm (35in)

This broad, straight, two-edged blade retains traces of an inlaid inscription – now indecipherable – and a scroll-design pommel, but its grip is missing. The sword is more tapered than earlier versions.

Fuller to
lighten blade



Thick, square-
section, downward-
pointing quillons

Broad, crescent-
shaped blade

▲ STRAIGHT-SIDED SWORD

Date 900–1000CE

Origin Scandinavia

Weight 1.5kg (3¼lb)

Length 90cm (35in)

The sword shown here is typical of Viking weapons, which were mostly straight-sided and of about the same size, with a simple cross-guard and pommel. Its blade is inlaid with a figure-of-eight mark.

Brightly painted
pattern

Edge bound
with leather
or iron

► PAINTED WOODEN SHIELD

Date 900–1000CE

Origin Northern Europe

Weight 5kg (11lb)

Diameter 70–100cm (28–39in)

Viking shields were made from wood and covered with leather. They had an iron boss in the centre, which could be used for striking opponents. This example is a modern replica.



Cutting edge
made of
hardened steel

Long handle
to allow two-
handed blow

◀ IRON AXE

Date c.900CE

Origin Europe

The example shown here is one of the three forms of Viking axe, the “bearded” axe. Its elongated lower edge and slanting blade were suited for downward blows.

